12.1.2 Executable specifications should be stored under version control

A given set of automated acceptance criteria is designed to run against a specific version of an application. If a new feature is added to the application, there must be a new version of the acceptance criteria that illustrates this feature. If developers are working simultaneously on different versions (or different branches) of the application code base, there should be matching different versions of the acceptance criteria (see figure 12.2).

In addition, the automated build process needs to be able to run the right set of executable specifications for a given version of the application, whether it's the latest build of the source code, a specific release candidate build, or a bug fix for a previous release.

Some tools let you store acceptance criteria scenarios away from the source code, in a separate database or managed in a separate application. The motivation behind these tools is to make it easier for non-developers to access (and take ownership of) the acceptance criteria scenarios. However, this approach poses a number of problems. For one thing, it makes the acceptance criteria much harder to associate with a

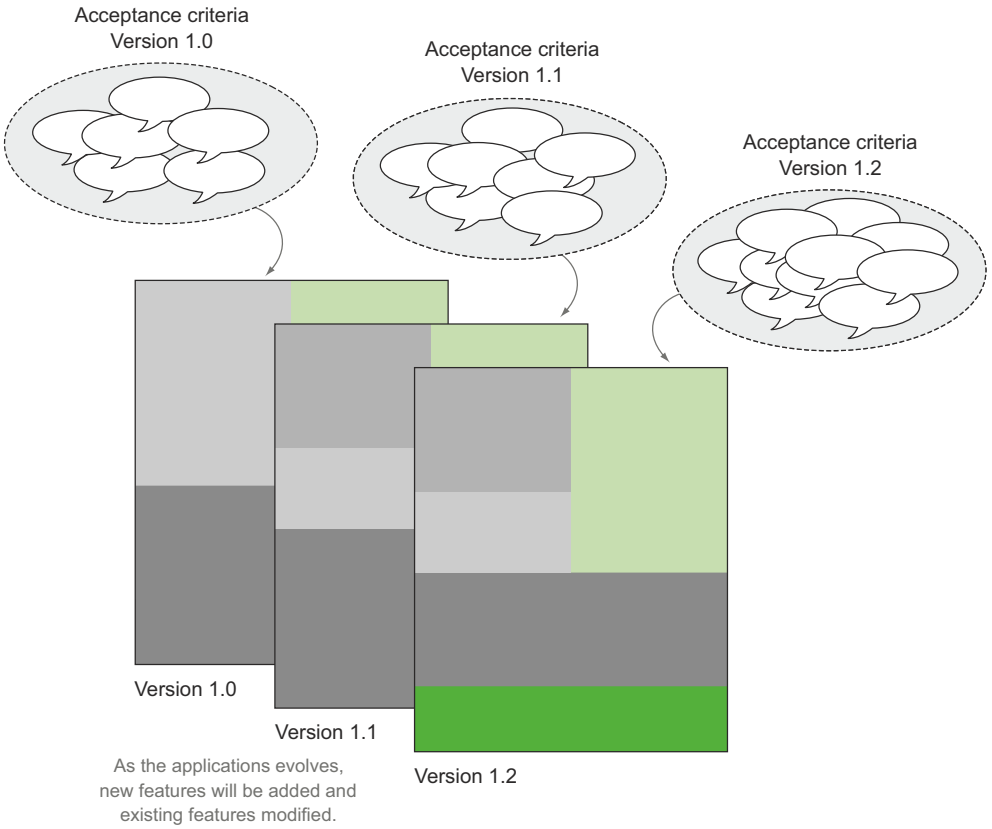


Figure 12.2 Acceptance criteria evolve alongside the application.